1. **Uneven distribution of land :** The distribution of land is highly skewed in rural areas. Therefore, majority of rural people work as hired labour to support their families.
2. **Lack of Non-farm Employment**: Non-farm employment opportunities do not match the increasing labour force. The excess supply of labour in rural areas reduces the wages and increases the incidence of poverty.
3. **Lack of Public Sector Investment**: The root cause of rural poverty in our country is lack of public sector investment on human resource development.
4. **Inflation**: Steady increase in prices affects the purchasing power of the rural poor leading to rural poverty.
5. **Low Productivity**: Low productivity of rural labour and farm activities is a cause as well as the effect of poverty.
6. **Unequal Benefit of Growth**: Major gains of economic development are enjoyed by the urban rich people leading to concentration of wealth. Due to defective economic structure and policies, gains of growth are not reaching the poor and the contributions of poor people are not accounted properly.
7. **Low Rate of Economic Growth**: The rate of growth of India is always below the target and it has benefited the rich. The poor are always denied of the benefits of the achieved growth and development of the country.
8. **More Emphasis on Large Industries**: Huge investment in large industries catering to the needs of middle and upper classes in urban areas are made in India. Such industries are capital-intensive and do not generate more employment opportunities. Therefore, the poor are not in a position to get employed and to come out from the poverty in villages.
9. **Social Evils**: Social evils prevalent in the society like custom, beliefs etc. increase unproductive expenditure.

10.6.2 Remedial Measures to Rural Poverty

Since rural unemployment and rural poverty are interrelated, creation of employment opportunities would support elimination of poverty. Poverty alleviation schemes and programmes have been implemented, modified, consolidated, expanded and improved over time. However, unemployment, begging, rag picking and slumming continues. Unless employment is given to all the people, poverty cannot be eliminated. Who will bell the cat?

Poverty Eradication Schemes	
Schemes	Year of launch
20 Point Programme	1975
Integrated Rural development Programme(IRDP)	1978
Training Rural Youths for Self-Employment (TRYSEM)	1979
Food for Work Programme (FWP)	1977
National Rural Employment Programme (NREP)	1980
Rural Landless Employment Guarantee Programme(RLEGP)	1983
Jawahar Rozgar Yojana(JRY)	1989
Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS)	2006

Chapter-10.indd 210 02/01/2023 16:06:40